

that point the North Vietnamese went public and revealed the text of the draft peace agreement, and the US was forced to seek revisions in accordance with Thieu's demands.

A new round of talks started in November 1972, but they were again inconclusive. Thieu sent Nguyen Phu Duc to Washington. Both the president and Kissinger told him that from January 1973, following the opening of the next session of the US Congress, it would not be possible for them to continue the war, but Duc refused to budge. Further secret talks between Kissinger and Le Duc Tho took place without result, and Kissinger yet again broke off the negotiations.